



Lights, Shadows, Action!

PLANRS ACADEMY — SHADOW PUPPET THEATRE MASTER COURSE | Grade 1 | 30 Minutes



Course Overview

"Every shadow tells a story — what's YOURS?"

Discover the magic of light and shadow through puppet-making, storytelling, and performance rooted in India's traditional shadow puppet arts.



The Big Idea & Hook

Have you ever seen your shadow following you on a sunny day? What if your shadow could TELL A STORY?

Mystery Shadow Game (3 min)

Look at the shadow on the screen — can you guess what's hiding behind it?

Find the hidden object and shout it out!



Learning Objectives



1

Explain what a shadow is & connect to Indian traditions

2

Show how distance changes shadow size

3

Make your own shadow puppet character

4

Perform a short shadow story

5

Name an Indian state with shadow puppet theatre





India's Shadow Puppet Traditions

Kerala & Andhra Pradesh — Where Shadows Dance!

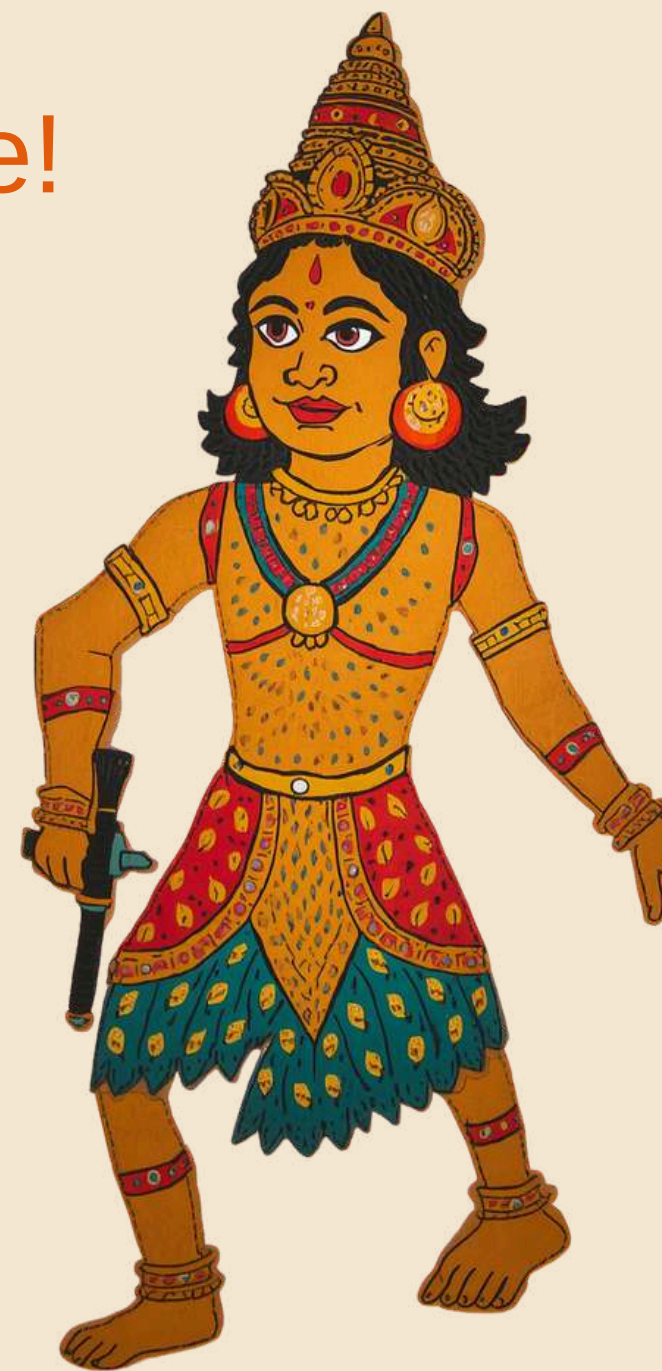


Tholpavakoothu (Kerala)

Beautiful leather puppets tell Ramayana stories at temple festivals — shadows come alive with music!

Tholu Bommalata (Andhra Pradesh)

Colourful painted puppets share exciting Mahabharata tales — big puppets, big adventures!





India's Shadow Puppet Traditions

Odisha & Karnataka — Ancient Art Forms

Ravanachhaya (Odisha): These special puppets are made from a single piece of deer skin! They tell stories from the Ramayana and have no joints — the whole puppet moves as one!

Togalu Gombeyaata (Karnataka): These puppets come in different sizes — big puppets for important characters and smaller ones for others. The bigger the puppet, the more important the character!



What is a Shadow?

A shadow forms when an object blocks light! Light comes from many sources — a bright torch, a glowing lamp, a warm diya, or the big sun in the sky.





Shadow Puppet Setup

LIGHT SOURCE → PUPPET → SCREEN → Audience

Distance changes shadow size:

- Closer to light = BIGGER shadow
- Farther from light = SMALLER shadow



Puppet Making Steps

Step A: Choose Your Character

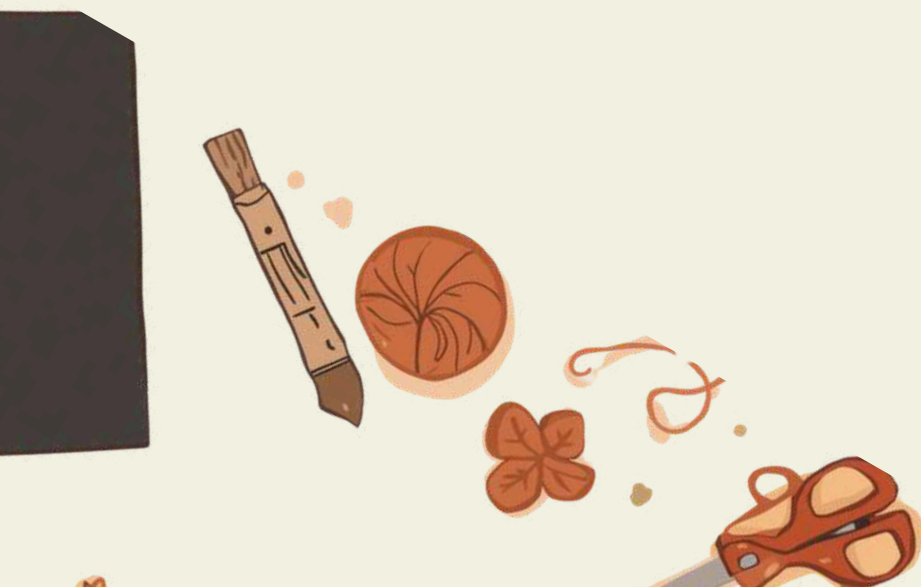
Pick who will be in your story! Will it be an animal like a peacock or elephant? A person like a farmer or dancer? A tree, boat, or vehicle? Dream big!

Step B: Draw the Silhouette

Draw a BIG, simple shape of your character. No tiny details needed — just the outline! Think of it like a shadow shape. Bold and clear works best!

Step C & D: Cut & Attach!

Carefully cut out your puppet shape. Then attach a stick or straw to the back as your handle. Now you're ready to make shadows dance!



Shadow Experiments

Size Magic

Move your puppet CLOSER to the light — watch your shadow grow BIG like an elephant! Move it FARTHER away — it becomes tiny like a mouse!

Angle Play

Tilt your puppet LEFT, RIGHT, or even UPSIDE DOWN! See how your shadow dances and changes shape. Make your puppet wave hello!

Partner Puppets

Find a friend! Bring TWO puppets together on the screen. Can your puppets meet, talk, or play? Create shadow magic together!



Story Structure for Your Shadow Show



START Your Story

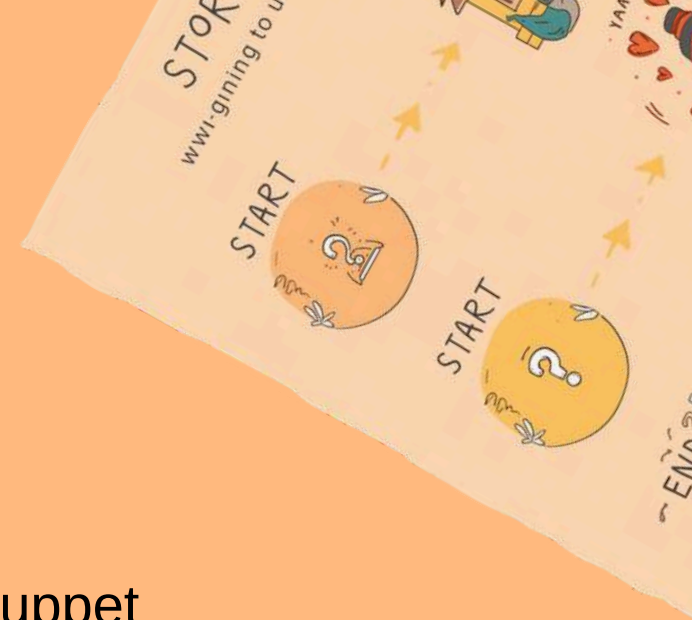
Who is in your story? Where are they? Introduce your puppet characters and set the scene — maybe a village, a forest, or a magical kingdom!

MIDDLE — The Adventure

What happens next? What problem do your characters face? Maybe the peacock loses its feathers, or the farmer needs rain for crops!

END — Happy Ending!

How does your story finish? Is everything okay? Show how your characters solve the problem and celebrate together!





Indian Character Examples

Animals: Peacock, Elephant, Crow, Snake, Cow, Fish, Tiger, Monkey, Parrot

Humans: Farmer, Grandmother, School child, Vendor, Dancer, Cricket player

Objects: Banyan tree, Mango tree, Boat, Diya, Moon and stars, Rain cloud, Village hut



Performance Rules



1

Be kind — every puppet show is wonderful!

2

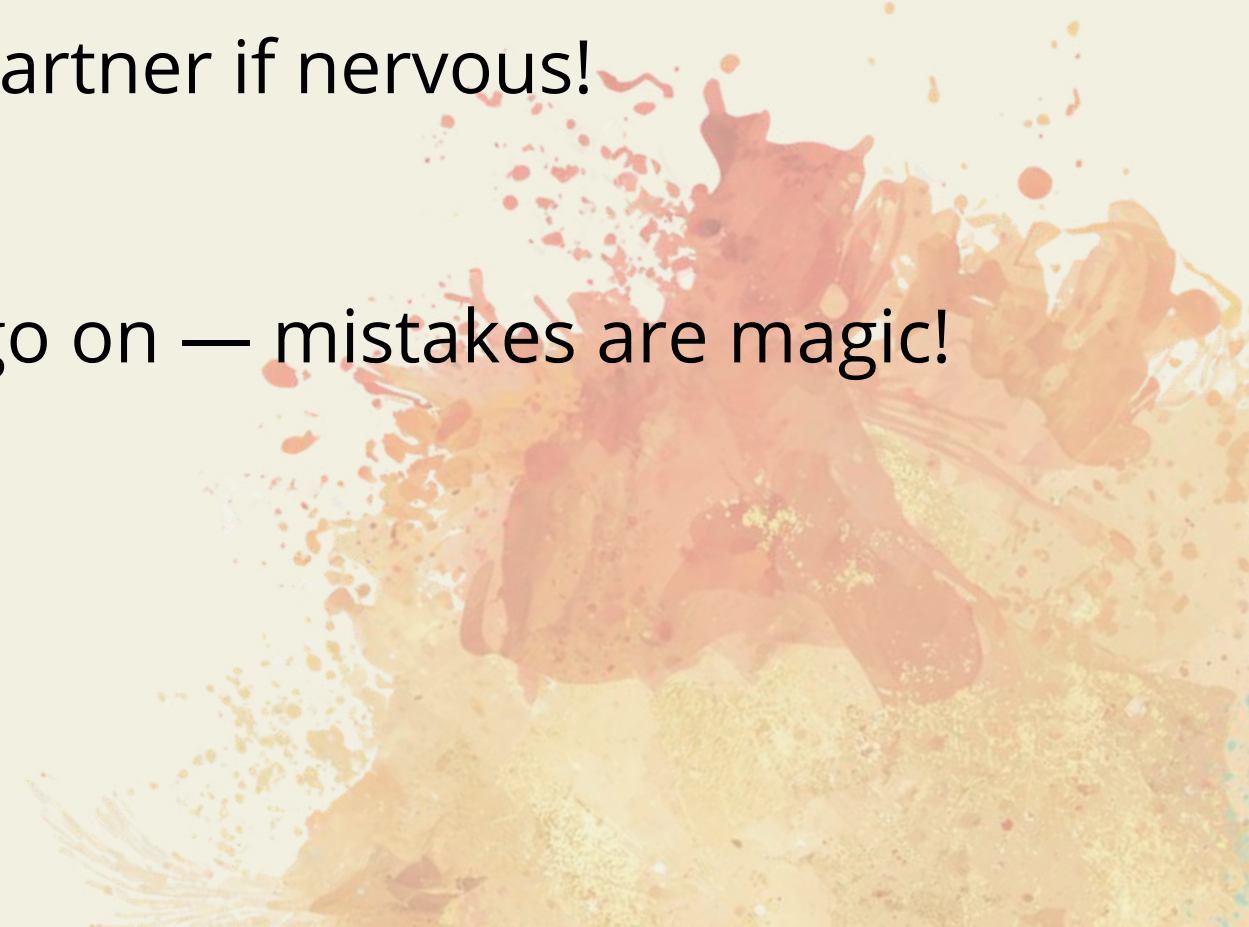
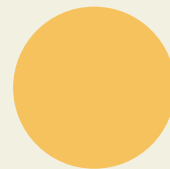
Audience claps after every performance!

3

Perform with a partner if nervous!

4

The show must go on — mistakes are magic!





Cultural Chant

LIGHT it! [mime torch shining]
BLOCK it! [hold hand in front]
SHOW it! [mime puppet on screen]
That's SHADOW ART! Woo-hoo!



Gallery Share & Badge Award



Share your puppets and stories in our
gallery!

You are now a CERTIFIED SHADOW
PUPPET ARTIST!

Every puppet you made tells YOUR
unique story. Be proud of your creation!





Parent Corner

"Today we became shadow puppet artists!"

Try this at home:

- Find a torch or phone light
- Hang a white bedsheet
- Use your puppet or make new ones
- Put on a family shadow show!

Ask your child to teach YOU!



Stretch Challenge!

Can you make a SECOND puppet?
Create a villain, a friend, or a magical
object! Make your story longer and even
more exciting!
What new character will join your shadow
puppet adventure?





Call — Our Shadow Puppet Adventure Ends!

Thank You!

Remember: Every shadow tells a story — what's YOURS?

